Day 27 - Roberts, Irwin Quarry, Walking Fern

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Toronto section · hike 35 · Silver Creek Conservation Area

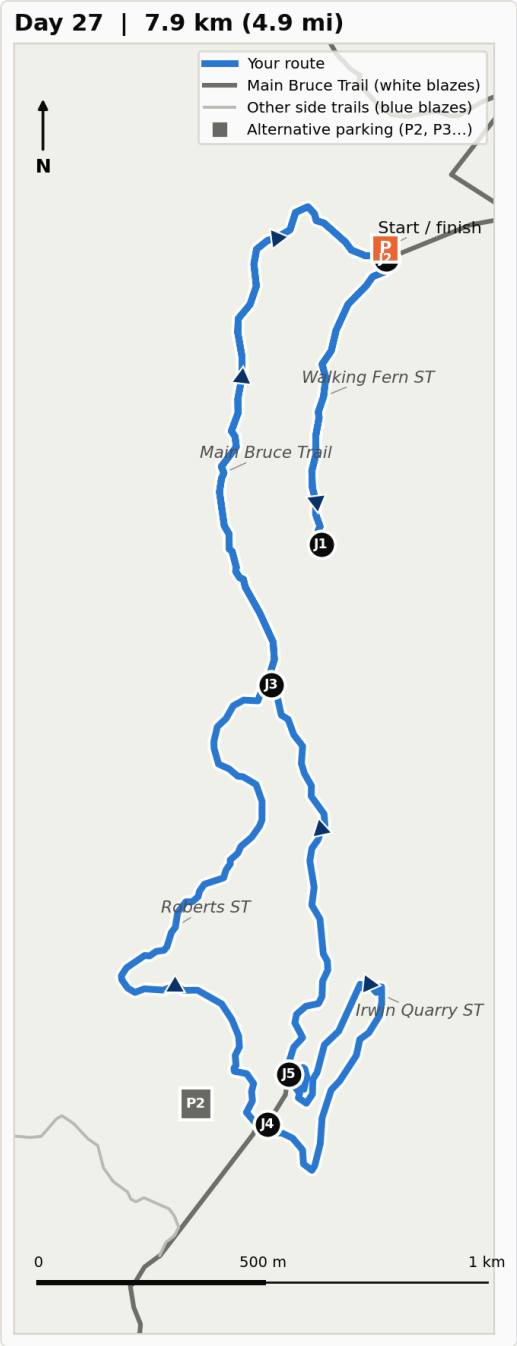
7.9 km / 4.9 mi	~2.2 h	3.4 km new	47 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

Park (P): Roadside parking on Tenth Line, 2.2 km southeast of 32 Sideroad (Halton Road 42) Google Maps. **Free**

Navigate: import *day27_hike035.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Roberts Side Trail (1.5 km); Irwin Quarry Side Trail (1.2 km); Walking Fern Side Trail (0.7 km)

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** Roadside on Tenth Line, 2.2 km southeast of 32 Sideroad. Silver Creek parking is roadside only and can fill on weekends from 11 a.m. to 5 p.m. Entry is free; no washrooms.
- **Walking Fern Side Trail:** Follows the valley bottom and is rated difficult. Look for walking fern and other unusual plants; CVC also notes an escarpment lookout.
- **Main trail:** CVC calls the Bruce Trail here strenuous, with long steep climbs, rocks, boulders, roots, fallen trees and narrow sections. Streams are crossed on wooden bridges.
- **Roberts Side Trail:** Rated moderate, through mature woods with a boardwalk past a pond that protects Jefferson salamander habitat.
- **Irwin Quarry Side Trail:** Rated difficult. It visits one of about 50 small quarries along the escarpment, worked because the soil over the limestone was so thin; the exposed limestone has since been replanted.
- **Dogs:** CVC lists dog walking on several Silver Creek trails.

Parking options

Alternative parking	Parking cost	Route km	Walk to trail	Closest side trails

P2	Silver Creek Education Centre: Enter from Fallbrook Trail northwest of the 27th Sideroad map	Free	4.4	230 m	Irwin Quarry, Roberts

Can't do it all in one go? Split it into two shorter outings: **Outing 1** from the planned parking (P): 1.4 km / 0.9 mi, covering Walking Fern. **Outing 2** from P2 (Silver Creek Education Centre: Enter from Fallbrook Trail northwest of the 27th Sideroad; Free): 4.1 km / 2.6 mi, covering Irwin Quarry, Roberts. The website's map shows which parts are already done.

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Roadside parking on Tenth Line, 2.2 km southeast of 32 Sideroad (Halton Road 42). Head south on the blue-blazed Walking Fern Side Trail.
0.7	0.4	J1: End of the Walking Fern Side Trail. Turn around and retrace your steps.
1.4	0.9	J2: You pass the start again. Keep going on the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading west.
2.8	1.8	J3: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Roberts Side Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
4.3	2.7	J4: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Irwin Quarry Side Trail, heading south-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left; the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
5.5	3.4	J5: Turn sharp right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
6.5	4.0	J3: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading north. (the Roberts Side Trail you already walked goes off on your left.)
7.9	4.9	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on Credit Valley Conservation, Hiking the GTA and the Guelph Hiking Trail Club.